

THE CROWN JEWELS



The Crown Jewels are worn by British kings and queens at their coronations. These include St. Edward's Crown, a golden orb, long pole-like scepters, a ruby ring, swords, and spurs. Most were made for King Charles II in the 1660s. Monarchs can only wear St. Edward's Crown for coronations. They use the Imperial State Crown for all other events. The Imperial State Crown has over 2,800 diamonds, but is lighter than St. Edward's Crown.

One by one she took the emblems of state—spurs, sword, robe, ring, orb, scepters, and the crown. Her mother (now known as the Queen Mother) looked on, along with Elizabeth's young son, Prince Charles. He was sitting just as she had sat to see her father crowned.

Afterward, to the shouts of “God Save the Queen!”, and thankful to be wearing the lighter Imperial State Crown, Elizabeth rode back through the crowds to stand on the palace balcony with her family. Newspapers spoke of “a new Elizabethan age,” looking back to her ancestor Elizabeth I, who became queen in 1558 at the same age (25). It seemed a new era. What would it bring for the young Queen?